English opening reading cards

Teacher preparation sheet - keep this page; cut only the card pages.

Start with one small focus. Use the letters and words needed for the chosen activity. Introduce only sound relationships the children have already met.

Choose the pages you need

Page 2: s, a, t, p, i and n cards for matching and building. Reveal only familiar letter sounds.
Page 3: first reading words — at, sat, pat and tap, with extra sat/tap model cards.
Page 4: add i and n — it, in, an, pin, pan, sit and tip, with extra pan/pin model cards.
Page 5: teacher-read labels — pan, cup and sun. Cup and sun need later taught patterns; do not ask children to read them independently yet.

Print, cut and reuse

Use A4 paper, single-sided, at 100% / actual size. Plain paper is enough; card is optional. An adult cuts along the borders before the activity. Keep the cut faces plain and the same colour. Put labels or set codes on the storage envelope, not beside the answer. No laminator, purchased kit, small magnets or loose decorations are needed.

Add a few hand-drawn pictures

Prepare separate, unlabelled pictures of a pan, cup, sun, sock, pen and pin as needed. Pictures are not included in these cards. Use a picture of a pin, never a sharp pin. Keep answer pictures separate when inviting print-first reading. Adult-read stories and listening games can use richer spoken words; that is not independent word reading.

Keep the teaching distinctions

Use with the related Reading & writing activities. Oral sound games need no letter cards. A child can match, point or build without handwriting. These printed shapes are not a stroke guide: tracing or copying uses an educator-confirmed formation model. Later words and sentences have their own resources.

Check printed cards for clarity and familiarity before classroom use.

Letters to match and build

Reveal only letters whose sound relationships have been introduced.

s	a	t
p	i	n
s	a	t
p	i	n

Our first reading words

Teach the relevant s, short a, t and p relationships and word meanings first.

at	sat
pat	tap
sat	tap

Add short i and n

Use after the actual patterns are taught. Extra pan / pin cards can serve as models.

it	in	an
pin	pan	sit
tip	pan	pin

Teacher-read labels

For stories and letter noticing. These labels are not all independent-reading words.

pan	cup
sun	pan
cup	sun